

Across Africa and its diaspora, oral storytelling traditions carrying centuries of values, humour, and history are increasingly lost or flattened as they are filtered through Westernized retellings, a problem AI risks accelerating by defaulting to Western narrative conventions when generating "African" content. This affects African and diaspora communities, educators, and younger generations encountering their own heritage through inauthentic representations. Left unaddressed, AI tools become instruments of cultural erasure rather than preservation. Our team is building a lightweight, fine-tuned small language model that generates original English-language folktales structurally and stylistically authentic to African oral traditions, spanning the continent's regions and its diaspora. Our solution is guided by cultural authenticity, inclusivity, respect, and transparency, curating balanced, properly sourced data and clearly framing outputs as AI-inspired, not a replacement for living oral tradition, aiming to support cultural preservation and representation, not substitute for it.